

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a current affairs website:

Bring back compulsory cooking classes at school

Until we teach kids to cook rice, make a simple stir-fry or prepare a low-cost spaghetti bolognese, people will continue to incorrectly believe that it's cheaper to feed your kids at a fast food restaurant than to cook for them at home.

And with a whole generation of adults who weren't taught how to cook, it's time cooking was made compulsory for all high school students.

It is doubtful that parents really think their children are better off eating fast food than something they've cooked themselves, but if you don't know how to cook, or you think you don't have the time, the idea can be terrifying.

Dietician Julie Gilbert said many parents now are completely overwhelmed by the huge choice of food in our supermarkets.

'They are lost and confused,' she said. 'We have completely de-skilled ourselves.'

Gilbert now has clients who have absolutely no idea how to prepare even the simplest of dishes, how the food groups work, or the vaguest notion of appropriate portion sizes.

There's a happy place in between gourmet and fast food and the only place left to guarantee we continue to get there is our schools.

Your group wants to discuss if every secondary school in Hong Kong should have compulsory cooking classes. You may want to talk about:

- why young people usually do not know how to cook
- the benefits and problems of having compulsory cooking classes
- what should be taught in these classes
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you bring your own food to school for lunch?
2. Would you like to have cooking lessons at school?
3. How important is home cooking in Hong Kong?
4. What new skills would you like to learn at school?
5. How can we get more people to start cooking?
6. Should cooking lessons be compulsory for boys at school?
7. Which subjects are more important at school: practical subjects or academic subjects?
8. Should cookery be made a degree course at university?

DO NOT TAKE AWAY